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■ Sheikh Mohammed honours Mohammed Bin Abdullah Al Gergawi in the presence of Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council.

Dubai has Dh2.1tr in projects under way

INVESTMENTS COVER REAL ESTATE, AVIATION, TRANSPORT

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Dubai has more than Dh2 trillion worth of projects under way and is preparing for a new phase of growth, His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, said yesterday, reaffirming that the emirate's rapid pace of development would not slow down.

Speaking after meeting 1,000 government and private sector leaders at the Mohammed Bin Rashid Leadership Forum, Sheikh Mohammed revealed that the total value of active projects in Dubai had reached Dh2.1 trillion, covering real estate, aviation, transport, infrastructure and initiatives aimed at improving quality of life.

Accelerating journey

"Our journey is accelerating, not slowing down. Our projects under way in Dubai are worth more than Dh2 trillion, and we are preparing for a new phase of growth and development. We will not stop," he wrote on X.

The forum, held under his patronage, brought together senior government officials, business executives and a new generation of young leaders to discuss Dubai's future and the importance of developing the talent needed to sustain its growth. "I was pleased to meet Team Dubai today at the Mohammed Bin Rashid Leadership Forum, 1,000 leaders from the public and private sectors, an outstanding group of promising young leaders, and a renewed spirit that will drive the next wave of change," Sheikh Mohammed added.

Dh1.1tr
accounted for by real estate projects through 2030

Dh128b
allocated to Al Maktoum International Airport

Figures released by the Dubai Media Office showed that real estate projects through 2030 account for Dh1.1 trillion, making the sector one of the largest components of Dubai's development plans.

Aviation is another major area of investment, with Dh128 billion allocated to Al Maktoum International Airport, which is being developed to become the world's largest airport.

Beyond aviation, more than Dh100 billion is planned for the development of the Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC), alongside Dh100 billion in projects by the Roads and Transport Authority (RTA).

Maintaining momentum

Sheikh Mohammed emphasised that the emirate would maintain its momentum as it prepared for its next phase of development.

"Our momentum is continuous and our achievements are ongoing. This is the ideal time to invest in Dubai and its infrastructure," he affirmed.

During the forum, he presented the Mohammed Bin Rashid Leadership Medal to Marwan Ahmed Bin Ghalita, Director General of Dubai Municipality, recognising his efforts to empower second- and third-tier leaders. He also awarded the Mohammed Bin Rashid Sash to Mohammed Bin Abdullah Al Gergawi, Minister of Cabinet Affairs, in recognition of more than three decades of dedicated public service.

SEE ALSO P4

Saudi Arabia hits Sanaa oil site; Houthis vow revenge

Coalition strike follows evacuation warning as Houthis threaten fresh attacks

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The Saudi-led coalition struck an oil facility near Yemen's Houthi-controlled capital yesterday, triggering threats of retaliation against Riyadh as the conflict escalated.

The strikes came shortly after the coalition ordered civilians to evacuate the Al Sabaha facility, west of Sanaa, operated by the Yemen Petroleum Company.

An AFP correspondent reported hearing an explosion, while residents told AP they heard blasts in the area. It was not immediately clear which facilities were hit. Earlier, Iran-backed Houthis warned that any Saudi attack would draw a "firm and painful" response, threatening to target Riyadh's international airport, a refinery, and an Aramco facility in Dammam.

UAE condemns

The UAE strongly condemned the terrorist attacks by the Houthi group targeting civilians and civilian and economic infrastructure in Saudi Arabia. The condemnation came during a phone call between Sheikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs, and Saudi Foreign Minister Prince Faisal Bin Farhan Bin Abdullah.

The escalation follows repeated Houthi missile and drone attacks on Saudi airports and energy infrastructure, including Saturday's strike on King Khalid International Airport that killed at least 13 people and wounded more than 300.

Fuel shortage fears

Following the evacuation warning, residents rushed to petrol stations in Sanaa, fearing fuel shortages, AFP reported.

The coalition said it intercepted three drones north of Riyadh yesterday. Riyadh airport operations remained suspended, while several airlines have halted services to Saudi Arabia. The Houthis have warned that direct US intervention would put American interests in the region at risk.

Saudi-backed forces are attempting to regain territory seized by the Houthis near the strategic waterway. Egypt's foreign minister urged the Houthis yesterday to halt attacks on Saudi Arabia and called for diplomacy to prevent further regional escalation.

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ABU DHABI

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Hackers heat supermarket fridges to 50°C

Cyberattack forces French retailers to discard fresh, frozen food

DUBAI

BY NATHANIEL LACSINA
Senior Web Editor

Hackers remotely raised refrigerator temperatures to 50°C at hundreds of supermarkets across France, spoiling fresh and frozen food and prompting an investigation into the cyberattack. The attack, which began overnight on Sunday, affected major supermarket chains including Intermarché, Coopérative U, Carrefour and E. Leclerc. A store in France recorded temperatures as high as 80°C, *Le Monde* reported.

According to Reuters, hackers took control of refrigeration systems and triggered automatic defrost cycles, raising temperatures and forcing stores to discard food that could no longer be safely sold.

At least 300 Intermarché and Netto stores, more than 100 Coopérative U outlets, and 80 Carrefour supermarkets were affected, according to retailer figures. Paris prosecutors said the attack had caused food losses and fires at some locations. Investigators have opened an inquiry to determine the extent of the damage and identify those responsible.

The attack reportedly targeted refrigeration controllers supplied by Danish manufacturer Danfoss, which allow supermarket operators to monitor and adjust temperatures remotely.